

PROVINCE	PRIVATE ROOM	ONE-BEDROOM SUITE
	COST PER MONTH	
Alberta	\$953–4,285	\$2,658–4,440
B.C.	\$995–3,500	\$1,595–5,400
Manitoba	\$1,359–2,475	\$1,690–3,300
New Brunswick	\$800–2,533	\$1,943–3,500
Newfoundland	\$1,500–1,800	\$1,065–4,200
Nova Scotia	\$1,705–3,100	\$1,900–3,490
Ontario	\$1,236–6,000	\$1,849–8,000
P.E.I.	\$1,825–2,880	\$1,950–3,750
Quebec	\$850–6,700	\$750–2,500
Saskatchewan	\$1,380–3,700	\$1,200–4,300

Source: LifestageCare © TakingCare Inc. 2013 (lifestagecare.ca).

When you look at these staggering costs, it becomes clear why I advocate for young people to start thinking early on about purchasing long-term care insurance. Some people say, “But, Kevin, I’m fit and healthy. I don’t think I’ll ever need it.” You don’t know that. No one does. According to a recent survey, 74 percent of Canadians admit to not having a financial plan in place should they ever need long-term care. Maybe you’re not part of that 74 percent, but your parents are. If so, it doesn’t make them bad people. They’re simply unprepared, just like the majority of the country.

Hopefully, you are reading this book before tragedy strikes. If so, there may still be time. If your parents are cognizant, open a dialogue. Urge them to invest in a long-term care policy immediately. A good plan will cover them in the event of chronic illness, cognitive impairment (dementia, Alzheimer’s), disability and other age-related conditions. Most plans include a waiting period of 30 to 90 days, so the sooner they act, the better. Encourage them to do this *before* they’re sick. Premiums can spike sharply depending on a person’s health at the time he or she applies.